

PAINTING WITH A LIMITED PALETTE

Before beginning a painting, try making a preliminary sketch of your subject. Use this sketch to help you work out which range of colors and tones to use to create a strong composition.

The simple watercolor sketch on the right was made in preparation for the painting below and many of the tones used were corrected, to create a more dynamic painting. In the finished painting, the palette is limited, with green as the dominant color. Using a range of greens has made the foliage interesting even though it is not very detailed. The tonal range of the neutral colors gives the painting structure, and the small amount of complementary red makes the painting more vibrant.

Preliminary sketch

Range of greens needs to widen to balance the barn roof.

Tonal value too light, it blocks the view of the barn's side.

The mid-ground area is too colorful and distracting.



Finished painting

